

SAFETY ALERT

OISD/SA/2026-27/P&E/03

Date: 10.04.2026

INTRODUCTION

Title: Fatal Fall from Height during Electrical Cable Laying Activity

Location: Hydrogenated Pyrolysis Gasoline Project Area

Loss/ Outcome: Fatality.

BRIEF OF INCIDENT:

The incident took place in a Project Area. During execution of electrical cable laying activity by the contract workman (hereinafter called Injured Person (IP)), the fall incident occurred at the junction point of East-West to North-South pipe rack. IP was working with proper personal protective equipment including a full body safety harness anchored to a secure point. Subsequently, he moved towards the North-South pipe rack through the horizontal portion of the cable tray to perform cable dressing activity. The cable tray arrangement consisted of three layers, and the workman was moving with his feet on the lowest cable tray while holding the top layer cable tray with his hands for support.

During the movement he had not anchored the full body safety harness. When the workman inadvertently held a loose overhead cable tray, he lost his balance and fell. The loose cable tray got stuck on the beam, while the workman fell approximately 2.8 meters to the ground level.

He initially appeared unharmed and was conscious. He was immediately shifted to the Occupational Health Centre, where first aid was administered. Subsequently, he was referred to a hospital and later shifted to a higher medical facility for further treatment. Unfortunately, the injured workman succumbed during treatment around 16 days later.

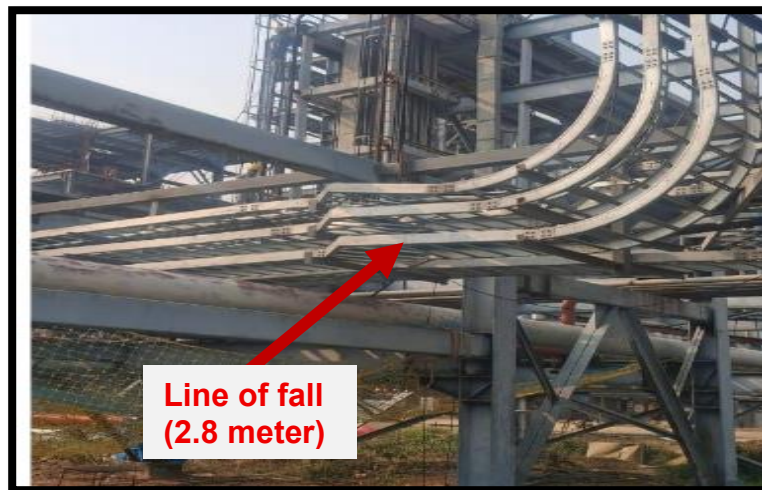
OBSERVATIONS / LAPSES

1. The IP was wearing personal protective equipment; however, the full body safety harness was not anchored during movement at height.
2. Proper walkway/ scaffolding had not been constructed for the job.
3. Illumination at the work site was not adequate.
4. Proper supervision was not done by the job supervisor during execution of the critical activity.

CONCLUSION/ ROOT CAUSE

1. Non-anchoring of safety harness during movement at height, indicating unsafe work practice and inadequate supervision.
2. Absence of proper scaffolding/ walkway for work at height.

This Safety Alert is based on the Investigation report submitted by industry and published for information purpose only. This information should be evaluated to determine if it is applicable in your operations, to avoid recurrence of such incidents.



RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Work at heights shall be carried out on properly erected and inspected scaffolding platforms. Scaffolding with adequate platforms, handrails, and all stipulated appurtenances shall be provided at all such locations in line with OISD-GDN-192.
2. Possibility of using secondary protection devices such as safety net or fall arrestor should be explored for execution of such jobs.
3. Adequate illumination should be available at work site, particularly where work at height is being carried out.

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